Chapter 2

# EARLY RESISTANCE TO INVADERS

*"The Muhammadan conquest of India is probably the bloodiest story in history. It is a discouraging tale, for its evident moral is that civilization is a precarious thing, whose delicate complex of order and liberty, culture and peace may at any time be overthrown by barbarians invading from without or multiplying within"*

**- Will Durant**



## LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Assess the causes of foreign invasions into Bharat and the destruction caused by the invaders
- Identify the bravehearts of Bharat who offered stiff resistance to the barbaric invaders
- Discuss the outcome and impact of the significant battles fought by the Bharatiya rulers against the unethical tyrants

## INTRODUCTION

In the beginning of the 8th century CE, the Arabs, having conquered Baghdad, Syria, Persia, Egypt and Carthage in northern Africa, crossed over the Gulf of Gibraltar and entered the Iberian Peninsula around 711 CE. The following year, they conquered Sindh as well. Since they now controlled both land and sea routes in the region, they were able to cut the direct link between Bharat and Europe, affecting trade and commerce. However, the valorous kings of Bharat prevented the influx of the Islamic invaders into mainland Bharat between 700 and 1000 CE.

During this period, Bharat flourished in every aspect and was known for her mastery over the subjects of mathematics, philosophy, logic, ethics, statecraft, military sciences, medicine, pharmacology, toxicology, veterinary sciences, astronomy and astrology. Arab authors like Sulaiman and Al-Biruni attempted to chronicle the same in their works. The systems, rules and customs of ancient Bharat were invaded, subdued and modified by a succession of conquerors. The invaders who came in brought with them a new religion, language and a new way of governance that unsettled the native spirit of the land.

## FORAY* OF ARABS AND TURKS

Bharat's citizens lived a life of abundance and prosperity. Those who arrived as visitors to witness the grandeur of our nation stood astonished and awestruck. At the same time, Bharat could also not escape the predatory eyes of a section of the globe. The Arabian and Turkic kings who held an intolerant religious belief, intending to establish Islamic rule in Bharat and to create a fortune by plundering our wealth forayed into Bharat from across the borders. Let us look into the attempts of invasions and the way Bharat's bravehearts defended and repulsed them at most times.

**Forayed :** To enter/invade into a new region

## EARLY ARAB INVADERS DEFEATED BY BHARAT'S RULERS

Attempt 1 : Around 636 CE - Naval attack on Bharat ordered by Caliph Omar at Thane.
Attempt 2 : 637 CE at Bharuch in Gujarat.
Attempt 3 : Around 643 CE - By sea at Debal (near modern day Karachi).

## BATTLE OF KIKAN

By 650 CE, the Arabs had established their power in France and Central Asia. Keen to conquer Bharat, the Caliph (Islamic head) sanctioned an expedition to attack the Sindh region again. A large army led by Haras Ibn Marra-al-Abdi reached the frontier of Sindh at a place called Kikan. Kikan, a small state near the Bolan Pass, was made up of different pastoral clans from the Jat community coming under the administration of Sindh. The Jats of Kikan crushed the superior military force of Haras. Haras was killed and a few survivors from his army retreated to inform the Caliph of the defeat. Sindh put up a brave front, under the leadership of **Raja Chach** (622 CE - 662 CE). His kingdom was very powerful extending up to the borders of Kashmir and Kannauj in the north and Kirman in the east.

| BATTLE OF KIKAN | |
|---|---|
| When? 663 CE | |
| Where? Kikan, Sindh | |
| Who were the combatants? | |
| Jats of Kikan | Caliph's army |
| Who were the commanders? | |
| Jat Commander | Haras ibn Marra-al-Abdi |
| **Outcome :** Arab army defeated | |
| **SIGNIFICANCE : Bravery of the Jats** | |

## SINDH DEFENDED BY RAJA DAHIR & RAJA JAISIMHA

Six attempts were made by the Caliph to capture Sindh. Five of the attempts were defeated by the kings of Bharat even though the armies of the Caliph were militarily superior in number and resources. It was only in 680 CE that Makran fell to the Arabs. To avenge the long years of resistance of Sindh, the governor of Iraq, Al Hajjaj sent Ubaidullah to raid Debal, a seaport in Sindh. Sindh was under the leadership of **Raja Dahir** (663 CE - 712 CE). In the battle that followed, Ubaidullah was killed and the Arabs retracted. A second and a larger army was sent under Budail. Army under Budail launched an attack on Sindh that was bravely defended by **Jaisimha**, the son of Raja Dahir. A pitched* battle ensued. In the end, the invading Islamic army was routed and Budail was killed.


Raja Dahir

## SINDH LOST

Unable to come to terms with the Arab army's humiliating defeats, Al Hajjaj despatched his nephew Muhammad Bin Qasim to attack Debal. In 712 CE, Qasim led the Arab Muslim armies into a fierce battle with Raja Dahir (663 CE-712 CE). One of Raja Dahir's chieftains, Mokah, betrayed his king and kingdom and joined the invaders. In the ensuing battle, Raja Dahir laid down his life. After Raja Dahir's death, his widowed queen Rani Bai fought bravely. When she could not withstand the attack, burnt herself along with other women to escape the infamy* of falling into the hands of the invaders. Women preferred to give up their life over being treated as slaves by the enemies, their honour came first. Sindh fell into the hands of the aggressors.

> "I am going to meet the Arabs in open battle and fight them as best as I can. If I crush them, my kingdom will then be put on a firm footing. But if I am killed... it will be said that Raja Dahir of Sindh sacrificed his precious life for the sake of his country, in fighting with the enemy."

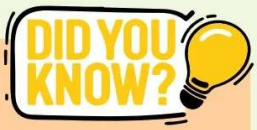
**Pitched :** Intense **Infamy :** Being infamous

Bharat got to see the viciousness* of the invaders. Raja Dahir's head was cut and sent to the Caliph. Qasim and his army killed the soldiers of Dahir, looted the wealth of Sindh and took the women and children as slaves. The captured people were converted to Islam. Temples were destroyed and mosques were built using the spoils of war. Bharat had not seen such cruelty during wars.

Mulasthana (present-day Multan in Pakistan), a great city with a grand civilization dating back thousands of years, fell to Qasim's army. It was considered a very important sacred pilgrimage centre like Kashi, Mathura and Prayag. The grand Aditya temple in Mulasthana was the nerve centre of the city. The entire wealth was plundered and a part sent back to the Caliph.

## SINDH RECLAIMED

Arab occupation of Sindh did not last long. Around 715 CE, Qasim who was the governor of Sindh was called back to Iraq where he died. Junaid Ibn Marri took over as governor of Sindh and tried moving further into Bharat during 723 CE. He set his eye on Ujjain only to face a defeat at the hands of an emerging hero of the times – Nagabhata I. Nagabhata founded the Gurjara -Pratihara dynasty, 'Pratihara' literally meaning 'gate keeper'.



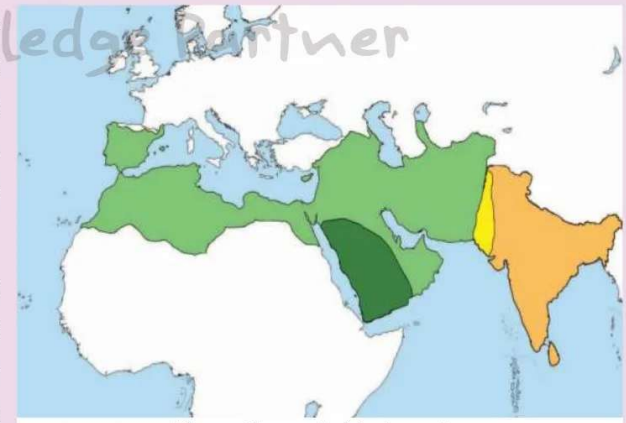

Pratiharas were considered to be the descendants of Lakshmana, brother of Sri Rama. Prince Lakshmana acted as a doorkeeper to his elder brother King Rama. Hence the Pratiharas adopted this title.

Nagabhata fought the invading Arab army and destroyed it. The Guhila army under Bappa Rawal helped Nagabhata in driving away the invaders. The Arabs then tried to gain access further north, through the mountains of Kashmir, where they were stopped and decisively defeated by Lalitaditya Muktapida in alliance with the king of Kannauj Yashovarman. The Arabs then tried the south route reaching a place called Navsari, which was under the prince Avani-Janasraya Pulakeshin belonging to the dynasty of Chaulukyas of Vatapi. Pulakeshin defeated the Arabs. Facing defeat at every location, the Arabs fled Sindh, crossing the river Sindhu. Sindh was thus reclaimed.

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### RESISTANT BHARAT

Have a look at the map. The area in dark green was the extent of the Arab empire after the death of Prophet Muhammad in the year 632 CE. By 712 CE, in just a matter of 80 years, the caliphates subjugated vast geographies marked in light green.


The rapid spread of Arab empire

In the case of Bharat, it took 70 years just to breach the border and occupy its farthest territories-Sindh (parts of current-day Pakistan, marked yellow on the map). Even their occupation of Sindh lasted for 20 years. They were pushed beyond river Sindhu effectively reducing their presence to two small states of Mansura and Multan.

**Viciousness :** Cruel and immoral

## FRONTIER FIREWALLS

Despite being one of the mightiest armies of the world, the Arabs feared some of the bravehearts of Bharat. Their very names sounded the death knell to invaders. We will now look into some of the unsung heroes who successfully defended Bharat.

### BAPPA RAWAL



Among those who drove away the Arabs, Bappa Rawal is a very significant warrior and statesman.
He destroyed the Arab armies and chased them into the deep desert beyond Ghazni. To fortify the northwest Frontier, Bappa Rawal built a city named Rawalpindi, which is still surviving in Pakistan today. From the military base in Rawalpindi, Bappa Rawal launched more than 15 attacks on Ghazni, Afghanistan expanding the kingdom of Mewar up to Iran. Great warriors like Rana Sangha, Maharana Pratap and Rana Uday Singh are all Bappa Rawal's descendants.

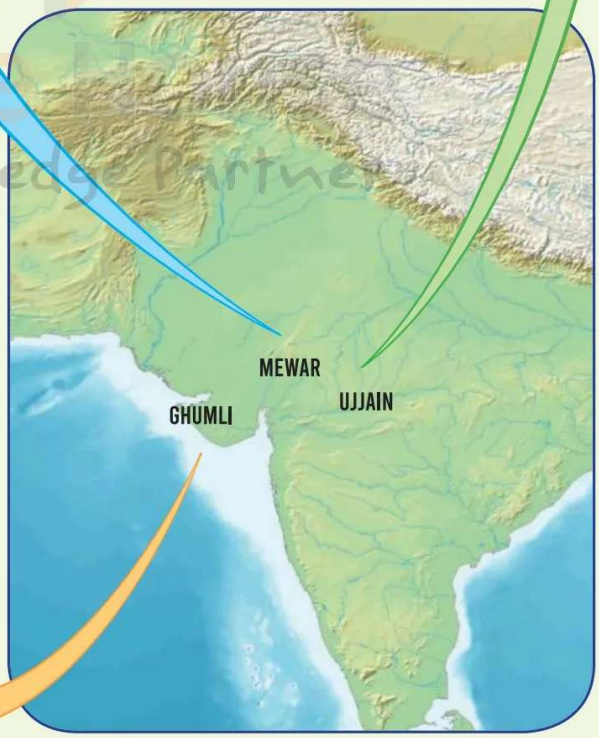
### MIHIRA BHOJA



Hailing from the Pratihara dynasty, Mihira Bhoja was one of the few kings who had a very long reign of almost 50 years. He was a nightmare to the Arabs who describe Bhoja thus: "This king maintains numerous forces and no other Indian prince has so fine a cavalry. He is unfriendly to the Arabs but acknowledges their greatness. Among the princes of India, there is no greater foe of the Muhammadan faith than he."

### AGGUKA I

Agguka I (r. c. 770 - c. 790) was a ruler of a lesser-known Saindhava dynasty of coastal Gujarat. In 756 CE the governor of Sindh sent a naval fleet against the Saindhavas which was repulsed by the strong navy of Agguka. Later in 776 CE, another naval expedition by the Arabs was defeated. Saindhava inscriptions that have been excavated provide the following details - Agguka I defeated the Arab navy and forced the Arabs to flee. Due to this the Caliph, Al Mahdi, gave up the project of conquering any part of Bharat through the sea routes. Agguka I was titled "Samudradipati" or "master of the seas".




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## CONTRIBUTIONS MADE BY THE DYNASTIES OF BHARAT

### KARKOTAS & LOHARA

The most famous emperor of the Kashmir Karkota dynasty was **Lalitaditya Muktapida** (724 CE-760 CE). This dynasty ruled over North-Western Bharat from 625 CE until 885 CE. The Lohara dynasty succeeded the Karkota dynasty.

Kalhana, in his book Rajatarangini praises king Lalitaditya's fierce military campaign in Northern Bharat and Central Asia. Lalitaditya's empire not only spread across major portions of Bharat, but also ran into present day Afghanistan and Central Asia. He commissioned several temples in Kashmir, including the Martand Sun temple. Kashmir's prosperity enticed Islamic invaders to want to gain complete control over it. Lalitaditya defeated Junaid, the Arab Governor of Sindh in a battle thus preventing the Arabs' attempt to plunder Kashmir. He also defeated the Momin of Uzbekistan four times and killed him in the fifth battle. Art, architecture, culture and learning flourished so greatly right through his rule that it went down in history as the golden age of Kashmir. He established several towns, including a new capital at Parihasapura while maintaining the traditional capital at Srinagar. Lalitaditya was a great ruler who impacted not just Bharat but also central and south Asia. Kashmir under Lalitaditya assumed prime importance in the political, spiritual and cultural spheres.



Extent of Lalitaditya's Empire


Martand Sun Temple

**DID YOU KNOW?**

The Rajatarangini of Kalhana highlights the wealth of Bharat during Lalitaditya's period. He constructed many temples in Parihaspura (22km northwest of current day Srinagar). The major temples housed grand deities (murthis) of :

- Parihasa Keshava made of 3,600 kgs of silver
- Muktha Keshava made of 979 kgs of gold
- Narhari suspended in air by fixing magnets above and below the murthi

Lalitaditya erected a copper statue of Buddha weighing 62,000 kg during his period. Most temples built by Lalitaditya were looted and destroyed when invaders took over the regions ruled by him.


Lalitaditya Muktapida

### BRAVE INDIAN QUEENS OF THE LOHARA DYNASTY

**Rani Sugandha (902 CE–906 CE)**

Rani Sugandha of Kashmir was married to Raja Shankaravarman of Utpala. Kalhana's Rajatarangini documents her as having accompanied her husband on many military conquests. On Raja Shankaravarman's untimely death, Rani Sugandha took over as regent of Kashmir and her young son Gopalavarman was placed on the throne. The towns of Sugandhapura and Gopalapura in Kashmir were built by Rani Sugandha.


Coins released during Rani Sugandha's rule

**Rani Didda (958 CE–1003 CE)**

Rani Didda of Kashmir was a powerful ruler who was the grand daughter of Raja Bhima Shahi. Bhima Shahi was the ruler of Kapisa (Kabul) and Gandhara (Kandahar). Didda's father ruled Lohara and she married the king of Kashmir, Kshemagupta. On the death of her husband, she ruled as regent for around 20 years after which she directly ruled Kashmir as its queen. Popular British archaeologist Aurel Stein remarks about Didda that she remained in peaceful possession of the Kashmir till her end, and was able to bequeath* it to her family in undisputed possession.



Coins released during Rani Didda's rule

## ISLAMIC INVASIONS ON BHARAT

The frontiers of Bharat were starting to get tested by the external invaders. Areas around present day Afghanistan were under the Hindu-Shahi kings who started facing these invaders. Sabuktijin (977 CE to 997 CE) was the first Muslim ruler who attempted the invasion of Bharat from the North-West.

### THE INVADERS FROM GHAZNI

The word Ghazni means Jewel. Ghazni was geographically in a strategic position. It was on the main path that connected Gandhara (now Kandahar) and southern Afghanistan. Ghazni was captured by Alp-Tjins the father-in-law of Sabuktijin. Sabuktijin started attacking the Shahi kings and this land route proved vital in the later invasions.

### RAJA JAYAPALADEVA, THE FRONTIER HERO

Raja Jayapaladeva, ruler of Udbhandapura belonged to the Hindu Shahi dynasty. The Shahis were kings of North-Western Bharat and commanded a vast region that included the Kabul Valley, Gandhara, Laghman, Kashmir, Sirhind, and Peshawar. Seeing the rising power of Sabuktijin, Jayapaladeva started strengthening his kingdom's defences. He also recruited the help of the previous ruler of Zabul, Abu Ali Lawik, to strengthen the defence. Not only was local help taken but also Jayapaladeva was able to convince rulers of far-flung kingdoms. Troops came from Ajmer, Delhi, Kannauj and Kalinjar. With this combined might Jayapaladeva attacked Sabuktijin in Ghazni around 987 CE.



Raja Jayapaladeva

The battle for Kabul was long and resulted in loss of many lives. Due to the harsh weather, Jayapaladeva was forced to negotiate for peace. However, it wasn't an offer of surrender.

In a letter to Sabuktijin, Jayapaladeva thundered,

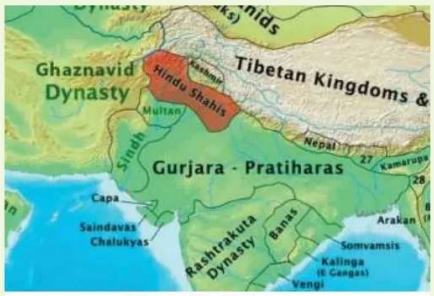
> "You know the nobleness of Hindus. They fear not death or destruction. In affairs of honour and fame we would place ourselves upon the fire like roast meat, and upon the dagger like the sunrays."

| BATTLE OF KABUL | |
|---|---|
| When? 987 CE | |
| Where? Ghazni | |
| Who were the combatants? | |
| Hindu Shahi | Ghaznavid |
| Who were the commanders? | |
| Raja Jayapaladeva | Sabuktijin |
| **Outcome :** Jayapaladeva loses | |
| **SIGNIFICANCE : Sabuktijin takes full control of Kabul valley** | |

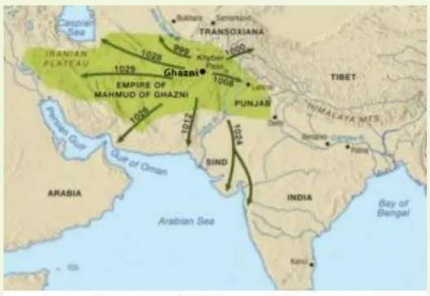
**Bequeath :** Entrust

The peace agreement was however short-lived. The fighting resumed and Jayapaladeva was defeated and driven out of Kabul. Sabuktijin now had control of the entire Kabul valley and the river Sindhu. Sabuktijin died soon after and a power struggle started. His younger son Ismail who was appointed his successor got overthrown by the elder son Mahmud, infamously referred to as Mahmud of Ghazni.

## RISE OF MAHMUD GHAZNI AND FALL OF RAJA JAYAPALADEVA



Hindu Shahi Empire



Empire of Mahmud Ghazni

Mahmud Ghazni on taking up the throne started consolidating power by gaining control over key regions of Central Asia, Seistan and Iran. He then shifted his focus to Bharat. Mahmud used the Caliphate's recognition that enabled him to command armies and attack Bharat. Mahmud Ghazni set out on a war to raise the standards of Islam and exert its dominance over the non-believers of Islam.

In 1001 CE Mahmud attacked Jayapaladeva near Purushapura (present-day Peshawar). During a period of time that was negotiated to be peacetime, Mahmud launched a surprise attack on Jayapaladeva's armies. Utter confusion within the ranks of Jayapaladeva's armies resulted in a quick win for Mahmud. Following his defeat, Jayapaladeva was taken prisoner.

What followed was massive loot and plunder of Jayapaladeva's kingdom. Hindu temples were broken. Jayapaladeva, his family and ministers were tortured, chained and paraded in the streets. Thousands of women and children were taken away as slaves and forcibly converted to Islam. Jayapala was then released on the condition that he would pay a compensation of fifty elephants plus 2,00,000 dirhams. Until then, he had to leave his son and grandson as hostages. After his release from Mahmud's bondage, Jayapaladeva wrote to his son Anandapala and publicly declared to his citizens that he was unfit to rule any longer. He thought himself unworthy of the throne he occupied, and burnt himself on a funeral pyre to which he set fire with his own hands. This was a demonstration of the Hindu sense of honour.

| BATTLE OF PURUSHAPURA | |
|---|---|
| When? 1001 CE | |
| Where? Purushapura | |
| Who were the combatants? | |
| Hindu Shahi | Ghaznavid |
| Who were the commanders? | |
| Raja Jayapaladeva | Mahmud Ghazni |
| Outcome : Jayapaladeva loses | |
| **SIGNIFICANCE : Mahmud Ghazni takes control of Peshawar** | |

## A WAR OF MANY FIRSTS FOR BHARAT

The attack by Mahmud was in many ways a kind of war that Bharat had not faced. There were no rules, ethics or concern for non-fighting people. Bharat is a land of honour and valour. Its kings followed the rules of war mentioned in Dharmashastras, Ramayana and Mahabharata This was in sharp contrast to the Islamic invaders who indulged in deception, treachery, and cruelty. Historical accounts of the invasions mention that the purpose behind the invasions was driven by religious ideology.

The invaders indulged in destroying all temples, large scale looting and destruction of cities, forcibly converting people to Islam, taking women and children as slaves for sale in overseas markets.

The Ghazni army used foul and vile tactics against the Hindu soldiers to disgust them on the battlefield. For example, they used faeces mixed in water and splashed on the fighting Hindu warriors. The Ghazni army took advantage of the disgust triggered in the Hindu soldiers and killed them

DID YOU KNOW?

Dr KM Munshi (Indian independence movement activist, educationist) says:

> The Indian Kings, all of whom accepted the law of Dharmasastras, waged wars according to certain humane rules. The shrine, the Brahmana, cow were sacrosanct to them. War being a special privilege of the martial class, harassment of the civilian population was considered a serious lapse. The high regard which all the Kshatriyas had for the chastity of women, also ruled out abduction as an incident of war.
>
> The wars in Central Asia, on the other hand were for the destruction of the enemies and for appropriating* the womenfolk…. When, therefore, Mahmud's army swept over North India, it saw torrents of barbarians sweeping its rich plains, burning, looting, indulging in indiscriminate massacre….burning down magnificent shrines enriched by centuries of faith, enforcing an alien religion at the point of sword, capturing hundreds of thousands of men, women and children to be sold as slaves in the market of Ghazni.

## RESILIENCE OF BHARAT

Over the next several years, Mahmud Ghazni captured Bhatia, Multan, Bhatinda, Nagarkot, Thanesar, Mathura, Kannauj, Gwalior and Banaras. Every city he conquered was subject to untold horrors. However, he was always met with brave resistance in all places and Mahmud had to suffer heavy losses. We explore here, some of the key events during his incursions* into Bharat.

### SANGRAMARAJA CRUSHES GHAZNI AGAIN AND AGAIN

**Sangramaraja** ruled the regions near Kashmir from 1003 to 1028 CE and founded the Lohara dynasty. Expansion of their kingdom was considered part of Kshatriya Dharma, duties of Hindu kings. They took great pride in their religion, ancestry and the inherited wisdom. The idea of forsaking all that the previous generations had held dear to them and accepting an alien religion under pressure was inconceivable to the Bharatiya royals like Sangramaraja.



Sangramaraja

| BATTLE OF KASHMIR | |
|---|---|
| When? | 1003 to 1021 CE |
| Where? | Tosha Maidan Pass, Kashmir |
| Who were the combatants? | |
| Kingdom of Lohara | Ghaznavids |
| Who were the commanders? | |
| Sangramaraja | Mahmud Ghazni |
| Outcome : Retreat of Mahmud Ghazni | |
| **SIGNIFICANCE :** **Mahmud Ghazni never returns to Bharat** | |

Sangramaraja had helped Trilochanapala, the grandson of Raja Jayapaladeva, to fight Mahmud's armies. To take revenge Mahmud Ghazni attacked Kashmir in 1014 CE. Entering through the Toshamaidan pass, Mahmud attacked the forts of Sangramaraja. The fort city was well defended by Sangramaraja's able forces. Mahmud tried attacking on multiple points but all were met with brilliant counter moves by Sangramaraja. The siege and fighting continued at multiple places for more than a month when heavy snowfall began in the region. Mahmud's armies were split and couldn't communicate with each other. The strong defence of Sangramaraja forced Mahmud to retreat. Mahmud Ghazni returned in seven years

**Appropriate :** To take possession of **Incursion :** Invasion

to attempt capturing Kashmir again. Yet again the brave soldiers of the Lohara king fought and drove away Mahmud. Tasting multiple defeats Mahmud retreated to never come back to Kashmir.

Similarly around 1018 CE, when Mahmud Ghazni was trying to invade the regions around Bundelkhand he was defeated by **Raja Vidyadhara Chandela** who stopped Mahmud's invasions into the east of Bharat. There were multiple defeats suffered by Mahmud Ghazni against Vidyadhara including the battle for the fort of Kalinjar around 1022 CE.

## DESTRUCTION AND REBUILDING OF SOMNATH



Ruins of Somnath Temple destroyed by Mahmud Ghazni

In 1025 CE Mahmud Ghazni started another round of plunder by entering Bharat and reaching all the way upto Modhera. However sensing increased resistance, Mahmud Ghazni decided to move back towards Mulasthan. In 1026 CE, he attacked the city of Somnath. Which anchored around the famous Jyotirlinga Somnath was a prosperous city which was plundered by Mahmud Ghazni. Many thousands of devotees of Somnath who had assembled to protect the Shivalinga were killed mercilessly. The Shivalinga was broken into pieces and the pieces were sent to be placed on the footsteps of the public mosque and a palace in Ghazni and Mecca for people to trample* over. The gold and precious items in the temple were taken away and the entire temple was set on fire.

DID YOU KNOW?

Mahmud Ghazni killed more than 40,000 people who were trying to protect the temple from getting destroyed.

Life returned to normal very quickly. Within 5 years Gujarat, richer and more powerful than before, rebuilt the Somnath temple on a more magnificent scale. It created the artistic wonders of the Dilwara temple. Neighbouring kingdoms, that included Malwa and parts of Gujarat, were enjoying great prosperity associated with the enthusiastic pursuit of learning, literature and art.

DID YOU KNOW?

- Somnath Temple before being destroyed had 3 lakh visitors during eclipses.
- 2000 villages were granted to the temple by various kings for the maintenance of the temple.
- Shivalinga was anointed with Ganga Jal brought from Haridwar, about 1500 km away.
- 2000 Brahmin priests were engaged to perform pooja.
- 300 barbers were employed to tonsure the devotees.
- One gold chain that supported a giant temple bell weighed 8000 kg. Its value today would be INR 3600 crores!

DID YOU KNOW?



The temple of Somanth was destroyed and rebuilt 17 times. Its final reconstruction was done when Bharat became independant in the year 1951.

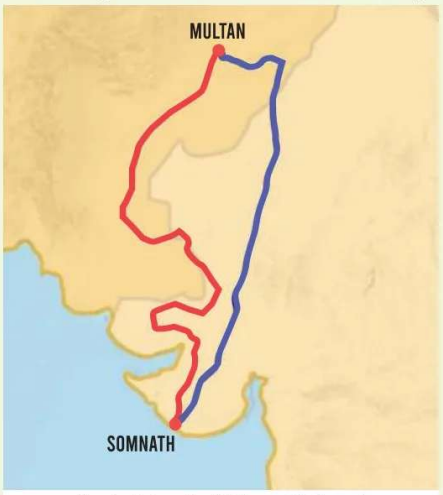
**Trample :** to walk over, heavily

## GHAZNI FEARS RAJA BHOJA - TAKES DETOUR



Raja Bhoja

After looting Somnath, Mahmud Ghazni started moving up towards Mulasthan. By this time, Raja Bhoja had organized an army to go after Mahmud. Raja Paramara Bhoja (Paramara dynasty) was one of the greatest kings of Bharat. He was not only a great military leader but also one of the greatest intellectuals. He wrote more than 80 books on topics ranging from grammar, music and poetics to architecture, chemistry, hydraulics, city and planning. Raja Bhoja had created a large army presence in Kathiawar through which Mahmud was planning to pass to reach Mulasthan (Multan). Mahmud decided to not risk passing through Kathiawar and was forced to go through a narrow inlet between Kutch and Kathiawar. Mahmud hired a guide to take his armies and wealth through the desert at Sindh. For three days the guide led them in circles within the desert. Many soldiers and war animals died of thirst. The guide, a devotee of Somnath, had outwitted Mahmud and was killed. As Mahmud and his armies neared Mulasthan, they were met by an army of Jats who attacked and killed many of Mahmud's soldiers and also took away part of the wealth. When Mahmud Ghazni reached Ghazni, he was left with a small fraction of his army and an even smaller portion of the wealth he had looted. Mahmud never returned to Bharat after this journey.




Route taken by Mahmud Ghazni

**Note:** the route in Blue was the ideal route that should have been taken. Ghazni and his army travelled in the route marked in Red across the great Indian Desert in the map.

**Impact of Mahmud Ghazni's invasion:**

1. Afghanistan and parts of Punjab were now under Islamic rule.
2. Mahmud Ghazni's tactics of invading Sindh became a proven example for the later invaders to follow.

### CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Assume you were in the city of Somnath when Mahmud Ghazni attacked it. Discuss how this invasion and plunder would have your life.

Orange House
Your knowledge Partner

## RAJA SUHELDEV DRIVES OUT THE LOOTERS

### SALAR MASUD'S ENTRY

Mahmud Ghazni met his end in 1030 CE. However, there were remnants of the Ghaznavid dynasty that had evil designs on Bharat. In 1031 CE, Salar Masud the nephew of Mahmud Ghazni charged into Bharat with a large army of more than 100,000 soldiers and defeated the Delhi ruler **Raja Mahipal Tomar** and proceeded on towards Kannauj. Using Kannauj as a base, Salar Masud started to attack regions like Barabanki, Bahraich, Sitapur, Lucknow and Shravasti in the region of current-day Uttar Pradesh.

### RAJA SUHELDEV'S TACTICS

Raja Suheldev was the eldest son of Raja Mangaldhwaja of Shravasti, chieftain of a small kingdom called. Suheldev was increasingly aware of the need to rid Bharat of invaders like Salar Masud. He brought together a federation of more than 21 Passi and Bhar chieftains who faced the risk of attack. However, unlike earlier kings, Suheldev was very aware of the unethical fighting tactics of invaders like Salar Masud. He understood that there were no rules that the invaders followed. Also, he understood that Salar Masud's army took cover behind cows when they came to battle as Hindus



Raja Suhel Dev

Suheldev was born in a socially under privileged family. But he rose to the level of a king, through his capability and valour.

would not attack cows. Multiple battles happened between the invaders and Suheldev's chieftains. After a minor setback, Raja Suheldev reorganized his tactics and army. After preparing for techniques to combat Salar Masud's army and their firepower, Raja Suheldev and his people were ready to fight Salar Masud's forces. In June 1033 CE, Raja Suheldev with his forces and with the active support of Raja Bhoja met Salar Masud's army at Chittaura Jheel in present day Bahraich.

## BATTLE OF BAHRAICH

A fierce battle at Bahraich between the invaders and Bharatiyas under Raja Suheldev resulted in heavy casualties. Raja Suheldev was well prepared, making sure that he had reserve forces to come in at the correct time to keep attacking. Raja Suheldev went after Salar Masud and in the fight between them wounded him severely. The main commanders of Salar Masud were also killed or severely injured. With their leader down and their generals out of action, Salar Masud's army was headless. Salar Masud and his generals pleaded for mercy. They requested to be let go with their lives. Suheldev understood that if he allowed Salas Masud and his army to retreat, they would go back, recoup and attack Bharat again with a strengthened force. This would be very harmful for the people of Bharat. At this point, Raja Suheldev did what most kings of Bharat had failed to do. He killed Salar Masud and his generals. A few soldiers were spared to take the news back to the land of Ghazni.

| BATTLE OF BAHRAICH | |
|---|---|
| When? | 13 & 14 June 1033 CE |
| Where? | Bahraich, Uttar Pradesh |
| Who were the combatants? | |
| Kingdom of Shravasti | Ghaznavids |
| Who were the commanders? | |
| Raja Suhel Dev | Salar Masud |
| Outcome : Decisive Victory of Suhel Dev | |
| **SIGNIFICANCE : No Islamic invasions for the next 150 years** | |

News of the complete destruction of the Ghaznavid army and the bravery and strictness of Raja Suheldev and his people spread far and wide. Salar Masud's defeat reached regions even beyond Ghazni. The Battle of Bahraich ensured that for the next 150 years, no Muslim invader set foot on the soil of Bharat out of fear.

Due to Raja Suheldev, Bharat was free from invasions for almost 150 years. That is, Bharat was free from the plunder of its wealth, destruction of its temples and its women and children were not taken as slaves. What would have been Bharat's loss if Raja Suhel Dev had only thought about his small kingdom and did not take the initiative to bring together several chieftains of the region?

## CONCLUSION

Attempts of the Arab Muslim invaders who were ravaging Europe and Middle East were prevented for more than seven decades.

Noted historian KM Munshi in History & Culture of the Indian People – Vol. 4 writes.

> In spite of unremitting pressure, exerted for over centuries, the Arabs were only left with the two petty states of Mansura and Multan in the 9th and 10th centuries. When compared with their dazzling victories over the contemporary states in the Middle-East, in Europe and over Persia, this insignificant result obtained in India was a tribute to the superior military strength and political organisation of the Indians.

Notwithstanding* the military might of our kings, Bharat faced the type of wars that were unseen and unheard of. The rules of war were never followed by the invaders. The concept of a just war in Hinduism is based on right and wrong. The Arthashastra and Dharmashastras classified victorious kings into Dharmavijayi, Lobhavijayi and Asuravijayi. The Dharmavijayi extracts only a symbolic tribute from the defeated king. The Lobhavijayi takes over the territory and wealth of the vanquished*. The Asuravijayi, the cruelest, seizes the territory and wealth and kills all the soldiers of the defeated king. The Muslim invaders were far worse than even the Asuravijayi. They killed the people of the land, took the women and children as slaves, forcibly converted the surviving people to their religion, looted the wealth, destroyed temples, and committed unspeakable atrocities.

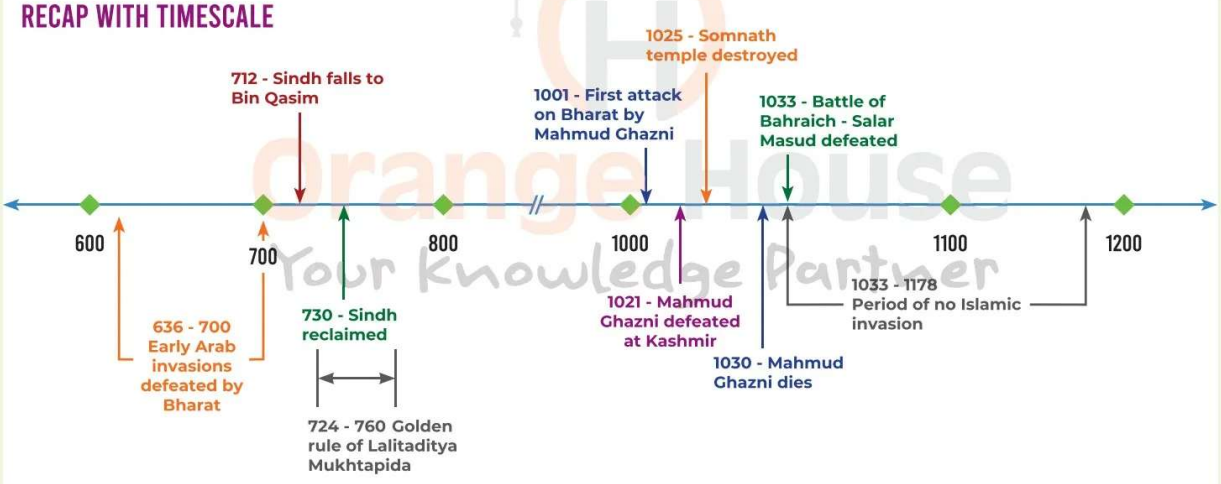
In the turn of the 11th century, many rulers of Bharat did not understand this vile* nature of the invaders and had to suffer the consequences at the hands of the Ghaznavids. However, there were visionary rulers like Raja Suheldev who understood the enemy and were able to prevent the influx of invaders for almost 150 years. As we turn the pages of history, Bharat faces its next challenge,

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## KEYWORDS

- Arabs and Turks
- Sindh
- Raja Chach
- Raja Dahir
- Muhammad bin Qasim
- Caliph
- Bappa Rawal
- Lalitaditya
- Karkota
- Rani Didda
- Kabul
- Mahmud Ghazni
- Jayapaladeva
- Battle of Kashmir
- Somnath destruction
- Raja Suheldev

## RECAP WITH TIMESCALE




# QUESTIONS

## MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. When Ubaidullah raided Sindh, _____ defeated him and saved Sindh.
   a) Raja Jayasimha  b) Raja Dahir  c) Rani Bai  d) Bappa Rawal
2. _____ was one of the grandest cities of Bharat and a pilgrimage place that fell in the hands of Qasim
   a) Mulasthana  b) Kashi  c) Prayag  d) Ujjain
3. Pratihara means _____.
   a) Teacher  b) Cook  c) Washerman  d) Gate Keeper

**Notwithstanding :** in spite of  **Vanquished :** defeat  **Vile :** immoral

4. Since 632 CE, the Caliphate expanded fast. But it took _____ years for them to breach Bharat's farthest boundary
   a) 10 b) 30 c) 70 d) 150
5. _____ built the city of Rawalpindi and launched 15 attacks on Gazhni from here.
   a) Nagabhatta I b) Bappa Rawal c) Mihira Bhoja d) Agukka I
6. Which of the following was not created by Lalitaditya Muktapida?
   a) Parihasa Keshava b) Muktha Keshava c) Somnath c) Marthanda Sun Temple
7. _____ was the founder of the Lohara dynasty
   a) Sangramaraja b) Jayapaladeva c) Lalitaditya d) Didda Rani
8. Which of the following rulers did not face Mahmud Ghazni in a battle?
   a) Jayapaladeva b) Vidyadhara Chandela c) Sangramaraja d) Rani Suganda

## REARRANGE THE FOLLOWING EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. (a) Rani Sugandha takes over as the regent of Kashmir.
   (b) Sabuktijin vs Jayapaladeva (Battle of Kabul).
   (c) Agukka I defeats naval expedition by the Arabs.
   (d) Death of Prophet Muhammad.
2. (a) Raja Paramara Bhoja blocks Mahmud Ghazni's route
   (b) Salar Masud enters Bharat
   (c) Raja Vidyadhara stops Ghazni from entering eastern Bharat.
   (d) Raja Jayapala is arrested by Ghazni.

## ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who won the Battle of Kikan? Why was it important?
2. Who wrote Rajatarangini? Name 3 kings/queens it elaborates upon.
3. What was the result of the Battle of Kabul?
4. How did the Arthashastra classify the victorious kings? Which category will the Islamic invaders fall under?
5. Which regions/kingdoms did the following rulers belong to:
   a. Raja Dahir b. Bappa Rawal c. Rani Didda d. Raja Suheldev

## ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Who were the bravehearts who defended Sindh when Muhammad bin Qasim attacked? Explain the aftermath of the war with examples.
2. How was Sindh reclaimed from Junaid Ibn Marri? Name the Bharatiya resistors and the routes that they protected.
3. Write in brief about any 2 of the frontier firewalls of Bharat.
4. Who was Lalitaditya Muktapida? How did he defend Bharat? Cite examples of prosperity under his rule.
5. Explain the resilience of Gujarat by citing the example of Somnath.
6. Explain the contribution of the following rulers in protecting Bharat and the impact of their actions on the invaders
   a) Raja Paramara Bhoja b) Sangramaraja
7. Why did Raja Jayapaladeva lose against Mahmud Ghazni? What was the consequence?
8. What happened in the Battle of Bahraich? How was it different from the earlier battles against the Islamic invaders? How did this war keep Bharat safe from invasions for 150 years?

Orange House Your Knowledge Partner

## CASE STUDY

What followed was large scale loot and plunder of Jayapaladeva's kingdom. Bharat had never seen such brutality and cruelty. All the wealth was plundered from the citizens of the area. Hindu temples were broken. Jayapaladeva, his family and ministers were tortured, chained and paraded in the streets. Thousands of women and children were taken away as slaves and forcibly converted to Islam. Jayapala was then released on the condition of receiving fifty elephants plus 2,00,000 dirhams till which time he had to leave his son and grandson as hostages. After his release from Mahmud's bondage, Jayapaladeva wrote to his son Anandapala and publicly declared to his citizens that he was unfit to rule any longer. He thought himself unworthy of the throne he occupied, and burnt himself on a funeral pyre to which he set fire with his own hands. This was a demonstration of the Hindu sense of honour.

1. How were the rules of war different before the Ghaznavids entered Bharat?
2. Was Jayapaladeva a good king? Support your answer with reasons.
3. Why did Jayapaladeva end his own life? What does it show about his principles?

## MAP WORK

Mark the following places on the outline map of India

- Ghumli
- Mewar
- Ujjain
- Ghazni
- Shravasti
- Mulasthana

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